

Candyrific Website Redesign Overview

Top-to-Bottom Plan

The goal of this project is to modernize the Candyrific website.

Specifically, this project will focus on accessibility requirements (up to WCAG 2.2), performance metrics (aiming for 90-100 on Accessibility, Performance, and SEO on Google Lighthouse), code maintainability and ownership, data integration, analytics, and the overall design/layout of the site. Additional features can then be added incrementally as I learn more about Candyrific's existing systems, specifically the broker login portal.

Code Quality and Accessibility

- The previous website appears to have had several accessibility issues. Improving accessibility will be a major focus of the redesign so that the site is easier to use for visitors with disabilities and is better aligned with current ADA and WCAG accessibility standards.
 - Businesses with public-facing websites can face accessibility complaints or legal action, making accessibility an important part of the redesign rather than an optional improvement.
 - The existing website uses jQuery and older development patterns. Although jQuery can still function, rebuilding the site with a more modern and organized structure (Vue.js - a frontend JavaScript framework) will make the code easier to maintain, test, expand, and hand off to future developers. I will be using either Vue.js or a custom folder structure for HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
 - CI/CD Pipelines with GitHub Actions will also be set up so that the website can be easily maintained and updated by anyone who wishes to do so. With this feature, additional "tests" can be performed to ensure that the frontend code maintains its quality
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Product Data and Dynamic Content

Depending on how Candyrific's data is currently stored, the site may be able to display dynamic sections such as Most Popular Products, Featured Products, New Products, etc. Before implementing these sections, I will need to determine if the data is in a state that permits that.

A simpler first version could allow Candyrific employees to manually select which products appear in featured sections and update the HTML manually.

Code Ownership

A private GitHub repository should be created under an account owned or controlled by Candyrific. This will allow Candyrific to retain ownership and access to its code instead of becoming completely dependent on a third party. Specific Candyrific employees and approved developers can be given access as needed.

Social Proof and Retailer Information

A gray-scale social-proof section will be added to show recognizable retailers and customers that carry Candyrific products. The “Where to Buy” map feature will stay as I believe that is a great feature.

Search-Engine Optimization

Search-engine optimization will be addressed during the rebuild rather than added after the site is complete. Most internet users are transitioning from traditional search to AI search. Nevertheless, Search engine principles remain the same.

For this reason, I will take one of two approaches to building the website:

1. Build with Nuxt.js, which automatically includes “server-side rendering” with Vue.js.
2. Build directly with Vue.js and create a custom “backend” script that builds the HTML on a daily “cron job” or when certain things happen like updates on a product.

Each of these will ensure that SEO is optimized on the site. Both approaches will provide excellent accessibility, SEO, performance, and “crawlability.” Google Lighthouse scores for Accessibility, Performance, and SEO will be between 90-100 and will be consistently monitored so that those levels are maintained.

Accessibility will be monitored and maintained through various tools including Google Lighthouse, WAVE Google Extension, and manual checking through a desktop tool called “NVDA.”

Analytics

Google Analytics or another analytics platform can be added to help Candyrific understand how visitors are using the site. This will allow future changes to be based on actual visitor behavior rather than solely on “opinions” about how the site should be arranged. Analytics should be configured carefully so that unnecessary personal or sensitive information is not collected. Candyrific should own the analytics account.

These analytics will show:

- Which pages receive the most traffic.
 - Which products visitors view most often.
 - Which buttons and links receive the most clicks.
 - Which regions of the page receive the most attention.
 - Which content is not being viewed.
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Hosting

The hosting provider should be selected after the broker login, database, backend, and content-management requirements are understood. This is a question in the “Questions” section at the bottom of this document.

Design

- The redesign will primarily use colors already associated with Candyrific, including the shades of red, yellow, blue, and purple shown in the brand deck Frank provided.
- The previous website font will be replaced with the updated typography identified in the brand deck that Frank provided.
- The design will remain colorful and playful with the addition of styling effects that make the website “pop”.
- Keep the “hero” image on the landing page but reduce its size. The site will start with one prominent “hero” image while more can be added later if it is necessary.

I will be considering the overall “design” of the website a group effort and changes made to the layout to be considered by any who wish to suggest. This will likely be a daily or at minimum, weekly discussion so that all opinions are considered incrementally. I personally think things should be more bold, colorful, and electric (mimicking the exact behavior of the products Candyrific sells), but there might be those who want a more standard/conventional design. I understand each side, so again, overall design and layout will be an incremental process, and everybody’s viewpoints will be considered.

Remaining Questions

- Is there an existing product database which stores product, sales, and inventory information?
 - How does the broker login currently authenticate users (this will likely influence the hosting provider)?
 - Is Broker Login a part of the website redesign? I will need to know a little bit more about Broker Login and how authentication works because this will impact which hosting platform I choose (AWS, Azure, or Netlify).
 - Will Candyrific employees need the ability to update website content themselves? If so, I will help specific employees set up their software development environment. Once I get everything up, updating the site is straight forward and I can serve as a direct point of contact.
 - What companies, websites, and/or platforms (CRM sites, etc.) will the site need to integrate with?
 - Where is product information currently stored?
 - Where is sales and inventory information currently stored?
 - **The most important question that has yet to be answered is:** What is the singular, main purpose of the website? Is the website solely for marketing purposes? Are we trying to guide them to buy product?
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Pay Structure

I am requesting a \$50 per hour fee.

Initial Phase Estimate

- **80–140 development hours**
- **\$4,000–\$7,000 total**
- **Approximately 6–10 weeks of part-time development**

Billing and Payment

- Can be paid every two weeks or at agreed project milestones.
- I will provide detailed information on completed work that I've done for each contracted hour or for work completed over a contiguous multi-hour timespan.

If the project is paused or ended, Candyrific will retain access to all completed and paid-for code and project materials.